Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction
- ✓ Introduction to Module 1 Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artistic Equivalents Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
- ✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology Video • 2 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Moons and Surfaces Reading • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912 Video • 3 min
- ✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009 Video • 1 min
- ✓ Surface, Scale, Technology Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
- ✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon Video • 2 min
- ✓ Photographs by NASA Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967 Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To? Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
- ✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon Video • 3 min
- ✓ Moon Phases Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941 Video • 3 min
- ✓ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Practice Memory Check Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction
- ✓ Introduction to Module 3 Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
- ✓ Facts and Fictions Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Fictions and Facts Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977 Video • 4 min
- ✓ Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996 Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
- ✓ Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936 Video • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937 Video • 1 min
- ○ **Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks** Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
- ○ Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents Video • 3 min
- ○ New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- ○ Practice Memory Check Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges Reading • 10 min
- ○ Optional Readings and Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

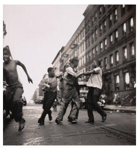
Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks

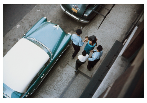
0:05 / 3:31 1x



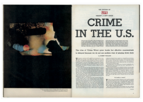
Gordon Parks. *Harlem Gang Wars*. 1948. Gelatin silver print, 10 15/16 × 10 1/2" (27.9 × 26.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of the photographer in honor of Edward Steichen. © 2020 The Gordon Parks Foundation

Gordon Parks was the first African American staff photographer for *Life* magazine. In the late 1940s, he proposed a story on the gang wars that were then consuming Harlem. Published in the November 1, 1948 issue under the title "Harlem Gang Leader," it was one of his earliest photo essays for the magazine. Parks used his camera to share a view of life inside the neighborhood amidst these clashes. At the heart of his story was Red Jackson, the young leader of the Midtowners gang. Parks shot hundreds of photographs that capture details of Jackson's life in contemporary Harlem. Some of the pictures revel in the ambiguity that the camera afforded. For example, this image of boys in the street could be read as playful if seen in a different context.

Of the hundreds of images Parks took, *Life*'s editors chose 21, which they cropped, printed, and sequenced into a narrative that emphasized the drama and sensation of the conflicts. Many magazine's photographers, including Parks, resented the way the meaning and interpretation of their work was skewed. In subsequent decades, several photographers who had largely depended on illustrated magazines for their livelihoods, sought to reclaim editorial control of their images by publishing them elsewhere, without such manipulation.

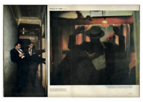


Gordon Parks. *Untitled, Chicago, Illinois*. 1957. Pigmented inkjet print, printed 2019, 13 3/4 × 21" (35 × 53.3 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Family of Man Fund. © 2020 The Gordon Parks Foundation



THE EDITORS OF
LIFE
PRESENT A NEW SERIES
CRIME
IN THE U.S.

Spread from "Crime in the U.S.", pp. 46-47. *Life Magazine*. September 9, 1957. Ink on paper, 14 x 21" (35.6 x 53.3 cm) overall. Collection of The Gordon Parks Foundation. Photo courtesy The Gordon Parks Foundation. © 2020 The Gordon Parks Foundation



Spread from "Crime in the U.S.", pp. 54-55. *Life Magazine*. September 9, 1957. Ink on paper, 14 x 21" (35.6 x 53.3 cm) overall. Collection of The Gordon Parks Foundation. Photo courtesy The Gordon Parks Foundation. © 2020 The Gordon Parks Foundation

Nine years later, *Life* Magazine asked Gordon Parks to develop a photo essay that would accompany the first of a series of articles discussing crime in the United States. Over the course of six weeks, he observed the streets of New York City, San Francisco, and Los Angeles, documenting varied aspects of the criminal justice system. Published in the September 9, 1957 issue, *The Atmosphere of Crime* featured an eight page photo essay illuminating the realities of police brutality and the prison system. The images included pictures of police officers patrolling streets, leading interrogations, arresting people, and violently exerting force. While Parks did not conceal the identities of his police subjects, his works carefully preserve the anonymity of those being accused of crimes. Commenting on the violence of law enforcement, Parks' photographs were as relevant then as they are now.

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